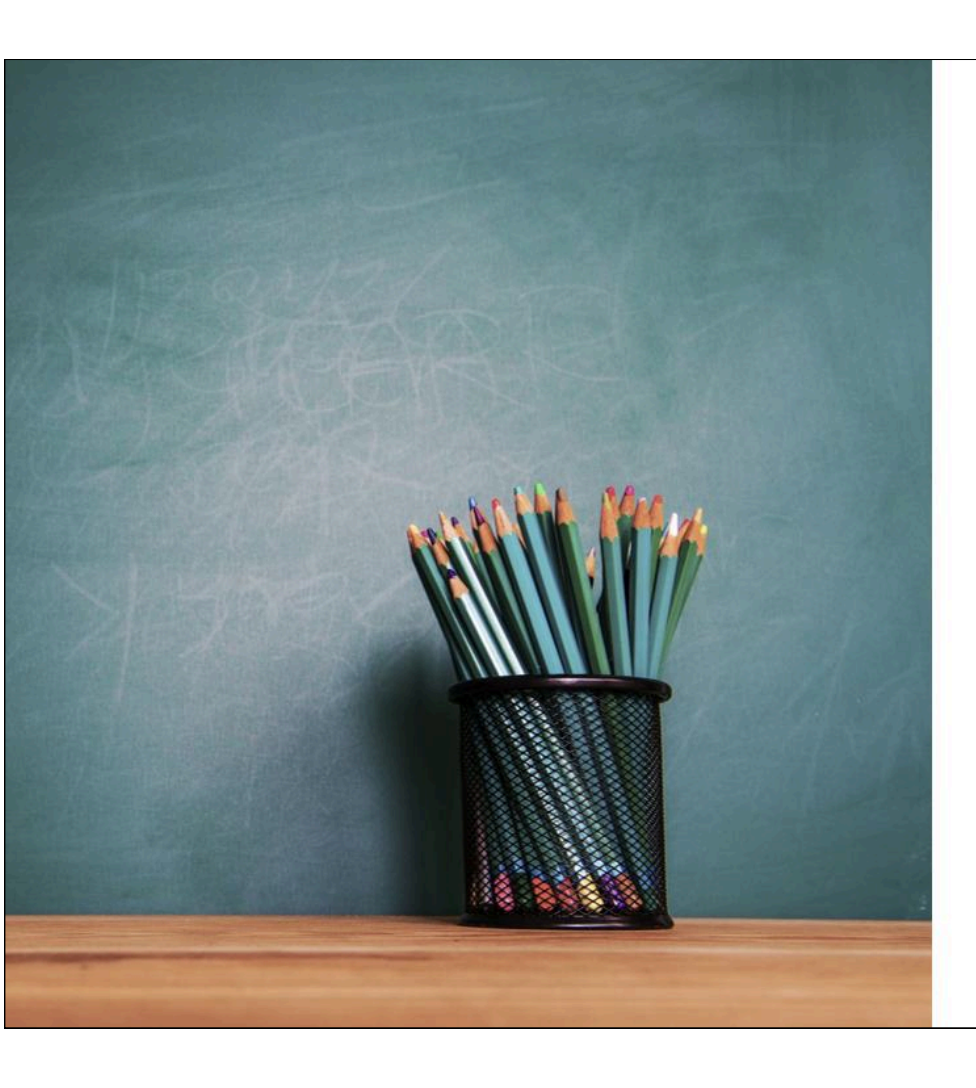


UX Research and Evaluation – Competitive Analysis, User Personas, and Usability Testing

.

Q. Perform a competitive analysis by selecting two similar digital products and comparing their UX strategies.
. Identify key strengths and weaknesses in usability, navigation, and user experience.
. Analyze how both products solve user pain points and differentiate themselves in the market.

Competitive Analysis

. Nykaa –

. Indian beauty and wellness e-commerce platform
. specializing in cosmetics, skincare, and fashion.

. Amazon –

. Global e-commerce platform.
. offering a wide range of products and services.

Aspect	Amazon	Nykaa
Usability	Clean interface with powerful search filters; quick checkout.	Visually appealing and personalized shopping experience.
Navigation	Efficient but slightly cluttered due to too many categories.	Simple and category-driven navigation; focuses on beauty verticals.
User Experience	Seamless order tracking and delivery updates; strong trust factor.	Personalized recommendations; limited cross-category experience.
Strengths	Huge product range, Prime benefits, excellent reliability.	Strong visual design, curated content, influencer-driven trust.
Weaknesses	Overwhelming interface for new users.	Limited product diversity compared to Amazon.

Market Differentiation :–

• Amazon differentiates through scale, speed, and reliability.
• Nykaa differentiates by focusing on beauty/wellness, curation, and influencer engagement.

How both products solve user pain points...

User Pain Point	Amazon's Solution
Too many product options make it hard to choose	Provides advanced filters (brand, price, ratings, delivery time) and "Amazon's Choice" badges to guide users.
Doubt about product quality	Verified buyer reviews, Q&A section, and return/refund policy to build trust.
Delivery delays	Amazon Prime ensures **1–2 day delivery** with real-time tracking updates.
Complicated return/refund process	One-click "Return or Replace" feature within the order page simplifies post-purchase issues.
Payment security concerns	Multiple secure payment methods (UPI, credit, COD) with OTP verification.

User Pain Point	Nykaa's Solution
Confusion in choosing right beauty products	Personalized product recommendations based on skin type, preferences, and purchase history.
Lack of trust in online cosmetics	**"100% Authentic"** guarantee and exclusive brand partnerships build credibility.
Difficulty understanding product use	Video tutorials, reviews, and influencer recommendations educate users visually.
Limited knowledge about what suits them	**"Beauty Advice"** section and quizzes guide users to suitable products.
Desire for inspiration	Curated "Looks" and blog-style content help users explore trends easily.

Q.Gather qualitative and quantitative user data through surveys or interviews.

. Prepare survey questions to collect insights about user behavior, frustrations, and expectations.

Survey Questions/quantitative

- **How often do you shop online for beauty/fashion vs general products?**
- **How satisfied are you with search and filter options?**
- **How likely are you to recommend either platform to friends?**

Ans we got :- • girls → 7/10 times
• 65% users said Nykaa is easier to browse for beauty items. Average time to find a product: Amazon — 3.5 mins; Nykaa — 2 mins.
- if for beauty products purchase → Nykaa 10/10. Else amazon.

Survey Questions/Qualitive

- **Which platform do you prefer and why — Amazon or Nykaa?**
- **What frustrates you the most when using these apps?**

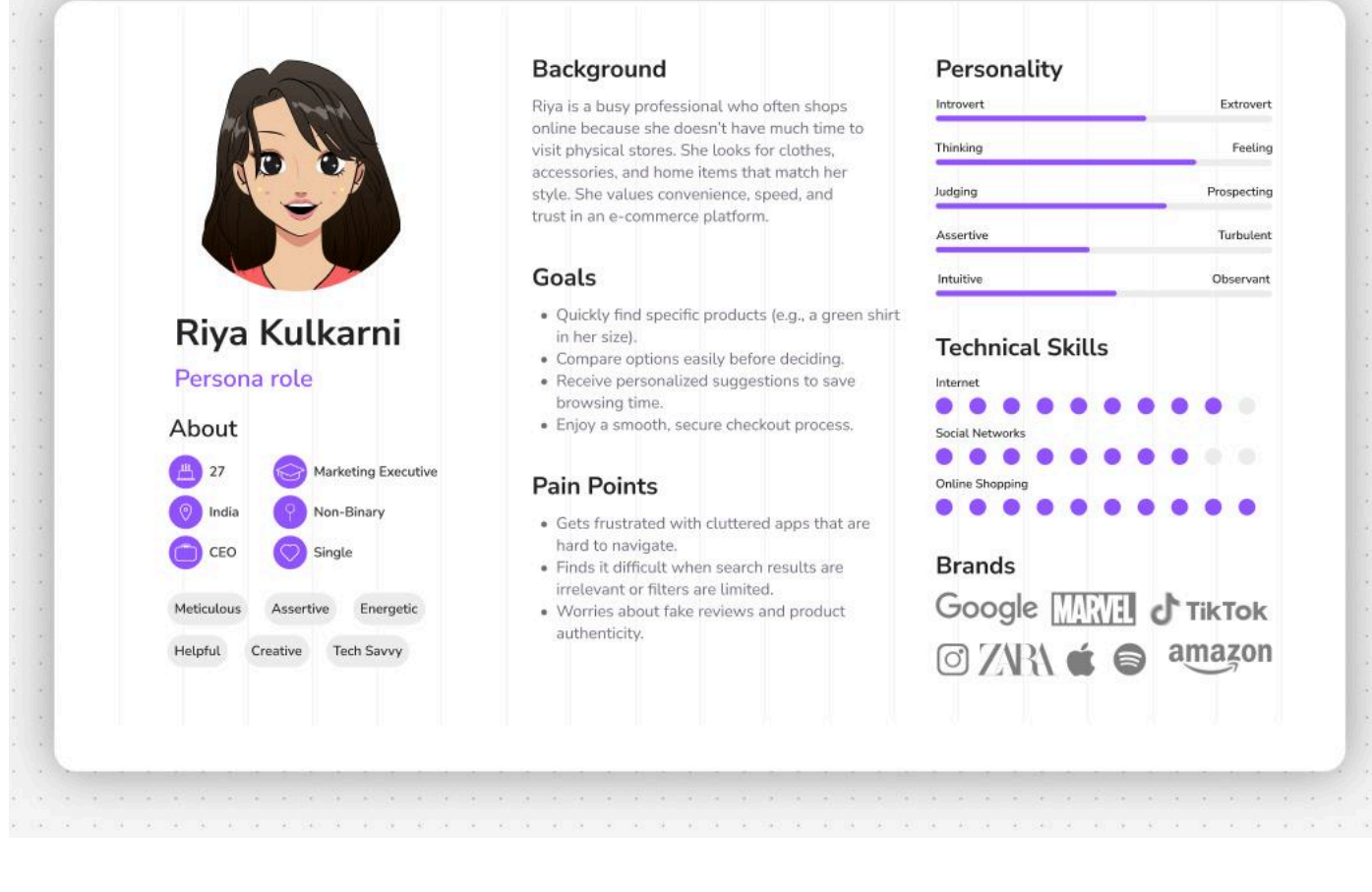
Ans we got :- • Users said Amazon feels "too crowded" and "takes time to find beauty products."
• Users liked Nykaa's "clean layout" and "beauty tutorials."
• A participant mentioned: "I trust Nykaa more for cosmetics, but Amazon is faster for delivery."

. Conduct at least one interview or user observation session to gather deeper qualitative insights.

Interview/Observation

• Observation: 5 users were asked to search and purchase a skincare item.
• Amazon: Users spent more time searching due to excess results.
• Nykaa: Users found it easier to compare beauty products and read reviews.

Q. Create user personas based on research findings.
. Develop at least two personas representing different user segments.
. Include demographics, behaviours, pain points, and motivations to define user needs.



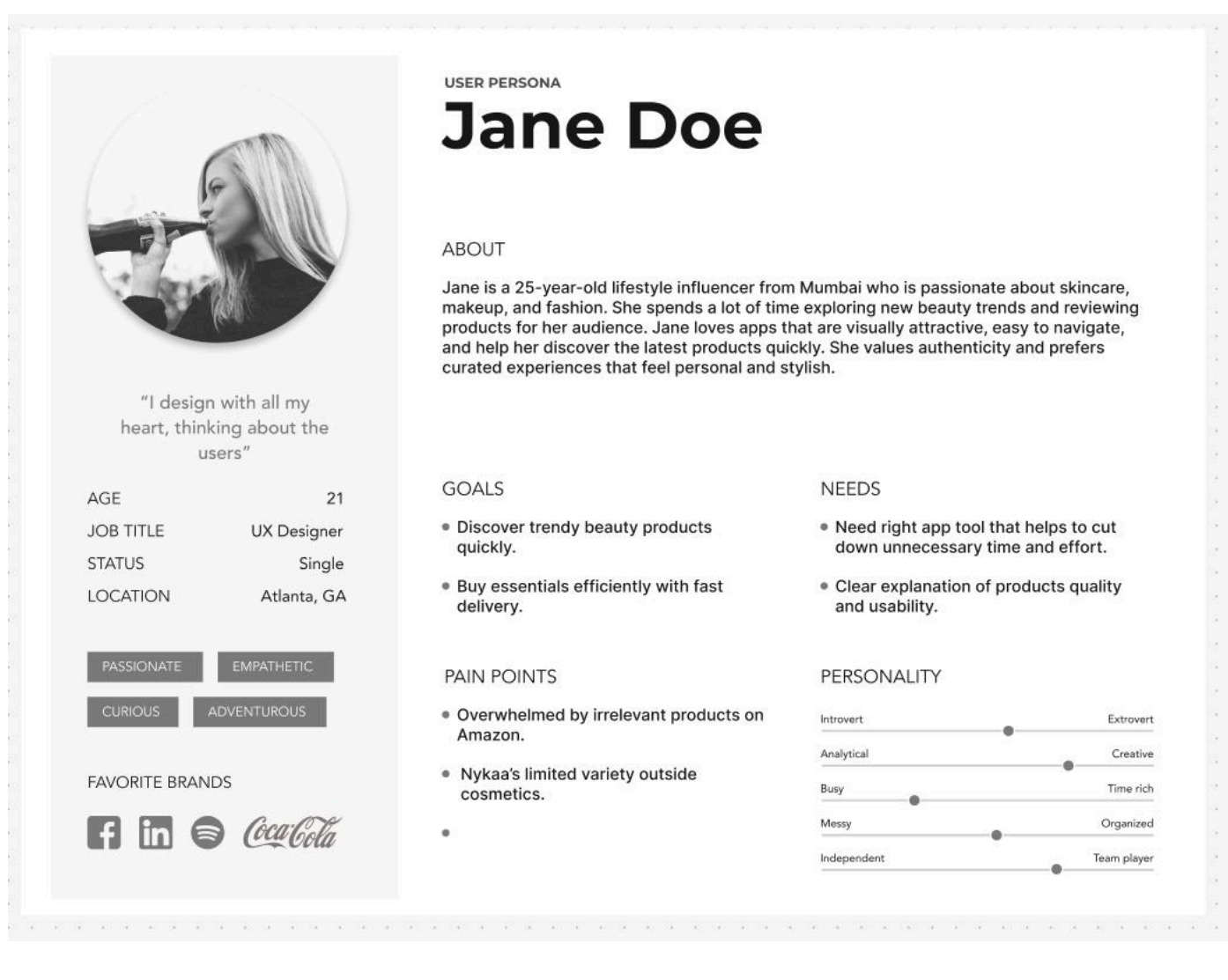
Riya Kulkarni
Persona role

About
27 | Marketing Executive
India | Non-Binary
CEO | Single
Meticulous · Assertive · Energetic · Helpful · Creative · Tech Savvy

Background
Riya is a busy professional who often shops online because she doesn't have much time to visit physical stores. She looks for clothes, accessories, and home items that match her style. She values convenience, speed, and trust in an e-commerce platform.

Goals
- Quickly find specific products (e.g., a green shirt in her size).
- Compare options easily before deciding.
- Receive personalized suggestions to save browsing time.
- Enjoy a smooth, secure checkout process.

Pain Points
- Gets frustrated with cluttered apps that are hard to navigate.
- Finds it difficult when search results are irrelevant or filters are limited.
- Worries about fake reviews and product authenticity.



USER PERSONA
Jane Doe

"I design with all my heart, thinking about the users"

AGE	21
JOB TITLE	UX Designer
STATUS	Single
LOCATION	Atlanta, GA

PASSIONATE · EMPATHETIC · CURIOUS · ADVENTUROUS

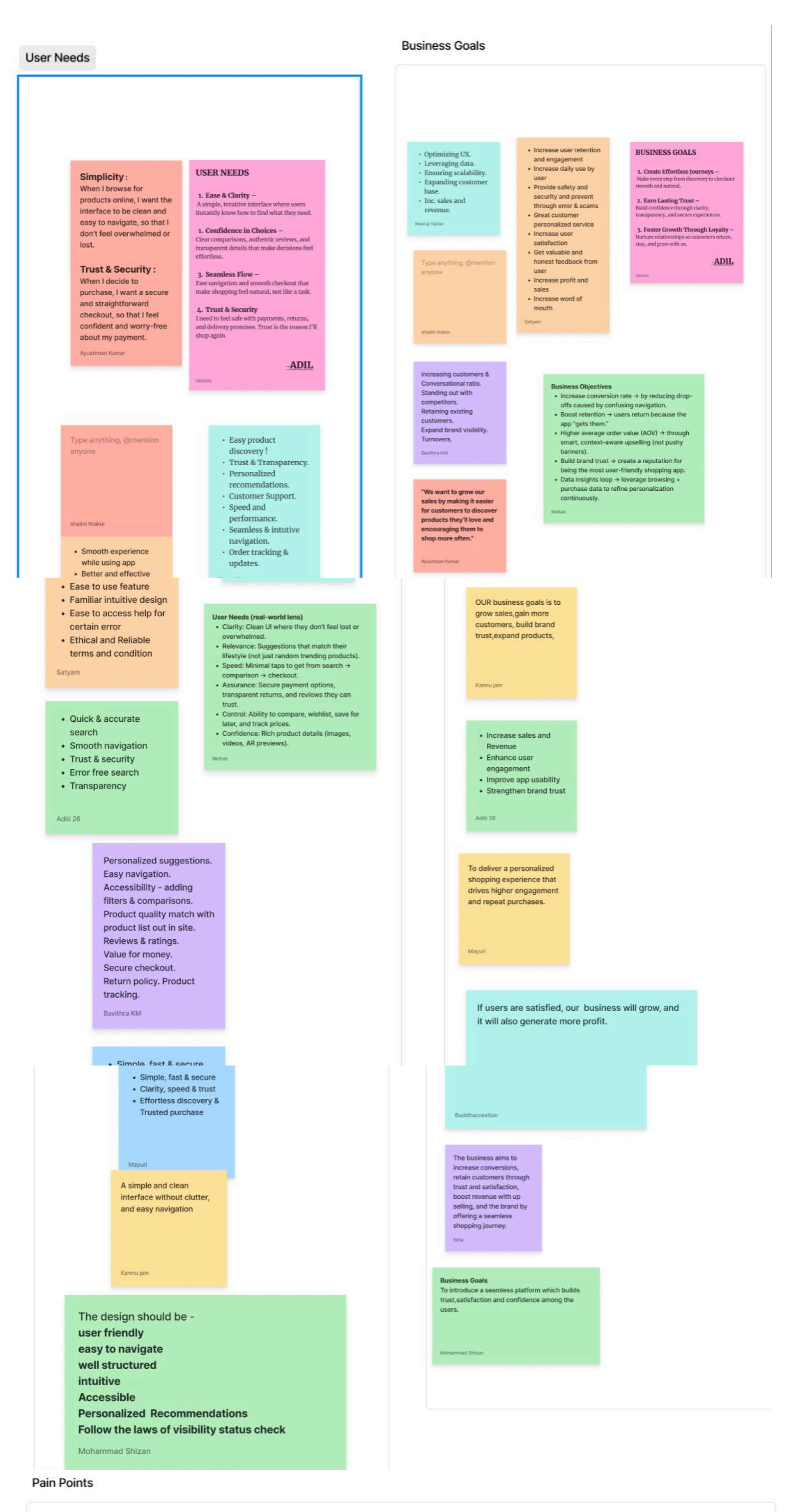
ABOUT
Jane is a 25-year-old lifestyle influencer from Mumbai who is passionate about skincare, makeup, and fashion. She spends a lot of time exploring new beauty trends and reviewing products for her audience. Jane loves apps that are visually attractive, easy to navigate, and help her discover the latest products quickly. She values authenticity and prefers curated experiences that feel personal and stylish.

GOALS
- Discover trendy beauty products quickly.
- Buy essentials efficiently with fast delivery.

NEEDS
- Need right app tool that helps to cut down unnecessary time and effort.
- Clear explanation of products quality and usability.

PAIN POINTS
- Overwhelmed by irrelevant products on Amazon.
- Nykaa's limited variety outside cosmetics.

Q. Use affinity mapping and card sorting to organize research insights.
. Identify recurring themes in user pain points and usability issues.
. Create a structured site map based on card sorting results to optimize information architecture.



User Needs

Simplicity : When I browse for products online, I want the interface to be clean and easy to navigate, so that I don't feel overwhelmed or lost.
Trust & Security : When I decide to purchase, I want a secure and straightforward checkout, so that I feel confident and worry-free about my payment.
Ayushman Kumar

USER NEEDS
1. Ease & Clarity – A simple, intuitive interface where users instantly know how to find what they need.
1. Confidence in Choices – Clear comparisons, authentic reviews, and transparent details that make decisions feel effortless.
3. Seamless Flow – Fast navigation and smooth checkout that make shopping feel natural, not like a task.
4. Trust & Security – I need to feel safe with payments, returns, and delivery promises. Trust is the reason I'll shop again.
-ADIL

Type anything, @mention anyone
shalini thakur

- Easy product discovery !
- Trust & Transparency.
- Personalized recomendations.
- Customer Support.
- Speed and performance.
- Seamless & intutive navigation.
- Order tracking & updates.

- Smooth experience while using app
- Better and effective
- Ease to use feature
- Familiar intuitive design
- Ease to access help for certain error
- Ethical and Reliable terms and condition

Satyam

User Needs (real-world lens)
- Clarity: Clean UI where they don't feel lost or overwhelmed.
- Relevance: Suggestions that match their lifestyle (not just random trending products).
- Speed: Minimal taps to get from search → comparison → checkout.
- Assurance: Secure payment options, transparent returns, and reviews they can trust.
- Control: Ability to compare, wishlist, save for later, and track prices.
- Confidence: Rich product details (images, videos, AR previews).

Mehak

- Quick & accurate search
- Smooth navigation
- Trust & security
- Error free search
- Transparency

Aditi 26

Personalized suggestions.
Easy navigation.
Accessibility - adding filters & comparisons.
Product quality match with product list out in site.
Reviews & ratings.
Value for money.
Secure checkout.
Return policy. Product tracking.
Bavithra KM

- Simple, fast & secure
- Clarity, speed & trust
- Effortless discovery & Trusted purchase

Mayuri

A simple and clean interface without clutter, and easy navigation
Kannu jain

The design should be -
user friendly
easy to navigate
well structured
intuitive
Accessible
Personalized Recommendations
Follow the laws of visibility status check
Mohammad Shizan

Business Goals

- Optimizing UX.
- Leveraging data.
- Ensuring scalability.
- Expanding customer base.
- Inc. sales and revenue.

Neeraj Yadav

- Increase user retention and engagement
- Increase daily use by user
- Provide safety and security and prevent through error & scams
- Great customer personalized service
- Increase user satisfaction
- Get valuable and honest feedback from user
- Increase profit and sales
- Increase word of mouth

Satyam

BUSINESS GOALS
1. Create Effortless Journeys – Make every step from discovery to checkout smooth and natural.
2. Earn Lasting Trust – Build confidence through clarity, transparency, and secure experiences.
3. Foster Growth Through Loyalty – Nurture relationships so customers return, stay, and grow with us.
ADIL

Type anything, @mention anyone
shalini thakur

Increasing customers & Conversational ratio.
Standing out with competitors.
Retaining existing customers.
Expand brand visibility.
Turnovers.
Bavithra KM

Business Objectives
- Increase conversion rate → by reducing drop-offs caused by confusing navigation.
- Boost retention → users return because the app "gets them."
- Higher average order value (AOV) → through smart, context-aware upselling (not pushy banners).
- Build brand trust → create a reputation for being the most user-friendly shopping app.
- Data insights loop → leverage browsing + purchase data to refine personalization continuously.

Mehak

"We want to grow our sales by making it easier for customers to discover products they'll love and encouraging them to shop more often."
Ayushman Kumar

OUR business goals is to grow sales,gain more customers, build brand trust,expand products,
Kannu jain

- Increase sales and Revenue
- Enhance user engagement
- Improve app usability
- Strengthen brand trust

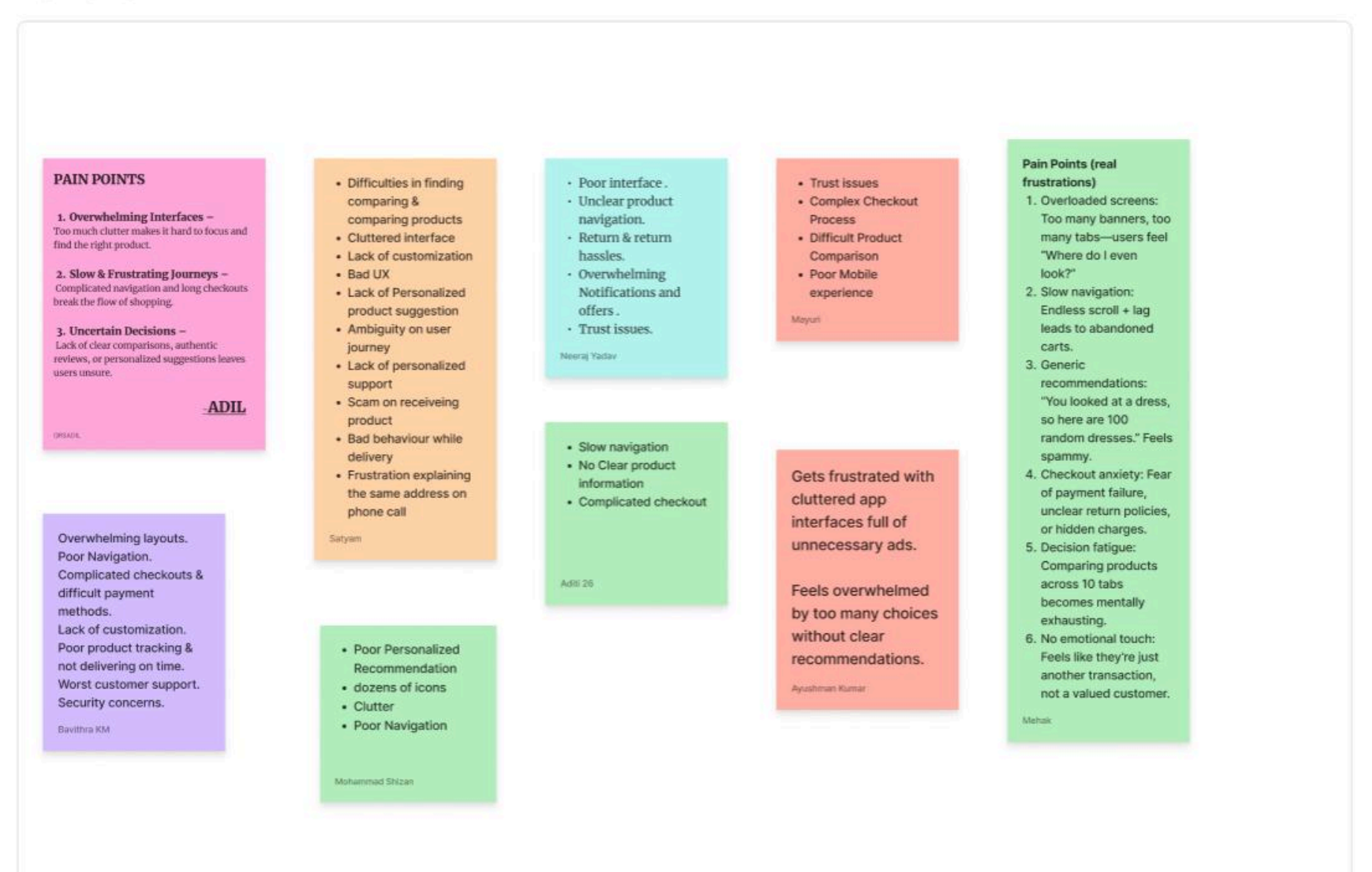
Aditi 26

To deliver a personalized shopping experience that drives higher engagement and repeat purchases.
Mayuri

If users are satisfied, our business will grow, and it will also generate more profit.
Buddhacreation

The business aims to increase conversions, retain customers through trust and satisfaction, boost revenue with up selling, and the brand by offering a seamless shopping journey.
Ekta

Business Goals
To introduce a seamless platform which builds trust,satisfaction and confidence among the users.
Mohammad Shizan



Pain Points

PAIN POINTS
1. Overwhelming Interfaces – Too much clutter makes it hard to focus and find the right product.
2. Slow & Frustrating Journeys – Complicated navigation and long checkouts break the flow of shopping.
3. Uncertain Decisions – Lack of clear comparisons, authentic reviews, or personalized suggestions leaves users unsure.
-ADIL

- Difficulties in finding comparing & comparing products
- Cluttered interface
- Lack of customization
- Bad UX
- Lack of Personalized product suggestion
- Ambiguity on user journey
- Lack of personalized support
- Scam on receiveing product
- Bad behaviour while delivery
- Frustration explaining the same address on phone call

Satyam

- Poor interface .
- Unclear product navigation.
- Return & return hassles.
- Overwhelming Notifications and offers .
- Trust issues.

Neeraj Yadav

- Trust issues
- Complex Checkout Process
- Difficult Product Comparison
- Poor Mobile experience

Mayuri

Pain Points (real frustrations)
1. Overloaded screens: Too many banners, too many tabs—users feel "Where do I even look?"
2. Slow navigation: Endless scroll + lag leads to abandoned carts.
3. Generic recommendations: "You looked at a dress, so here are 100 random dresses." Feels spammy.
4. Checkout anxiety: Fear of payment failure, unclear return policies, or hidden charges.
5. Decision fatigue: Comparing products across 10 tabs becomes mentally exhausting.
6. No emotional touch: Feels like they're just another transaction, not a valued customer.

Mehak

Overwhelming layouts.
Poor Navigation.
Complicated checkouts & difficult payment methods.
Lack of customization.
Poor product tracking & not delivering on time.
Worst customer support.
Security concerns.
Bavithra KM

- Slow navigation
- No Clear product information
- Complicated checkout

Aditi 26

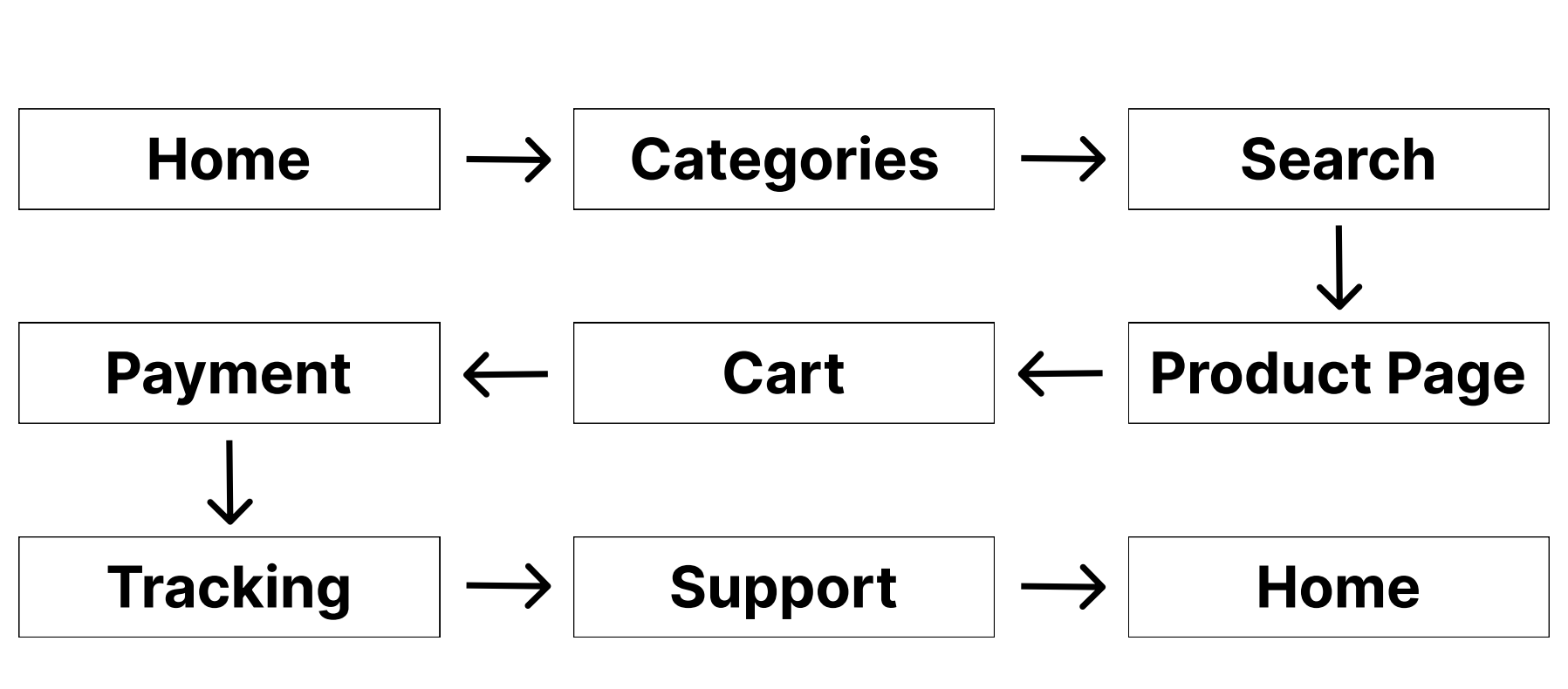
Gets frustrated with cluttered app interfaces full of unnecessary ads.

Feels overwhelmed by too many choices without clear recommendations.
Ayushman Kumar

- Poor Personalized Recommendation
- dozens of icons
- Clutter
- Poor Navigation

Mohammad Shizan

Information architecture/ sit-map



Q. Conduct a usability test and heuristic evaluation to assess UX problems in a selected digital product.
. Observe users interacting with the product and document usability challenges.
. Use Jakob Nielsen's Heuristic Evaluation framework to assess usability and accessibility.

Ans :-

Test Observations
• Users completed the purchase flow for a skincare item.
• Amazon: Took longer due to excessive suggestions.
• Nykaa: Faster purchase but weaker cross-selling experience.

Heuristic	Amazon	Nykaa
Visibility of system status	Excellent (real-time tracking).	Good, but limited in app notifications.
Consistency & standards	High consistency across platforms.	Slight inconsistencies between web & app.
User control & freedom	Easy cancellations/returns.	Slight delay in returns/refund flow.
Aesthetic & minimalist design	Informative but cluttered.	Clean and focused on visuals.

Accessibility

Aspect	Amazon	Nykaa
Color Contrast	Meets WCAG standards in most areas; good readability on both dark and light themes.	Uses high-contrast text for product names and prices, but some pastel tones reduce legibility.
Text Size & Readability	Adjustable font size (browser/app), clear typography, consistent hierarchy.	Clean and modern fonts; slightly smaller body text in product descriptions.
Screen Reader Compatibility	Strong ARIA labels, alt-text for most product images, and clear headings for assistive tools.	Moderate — some decorative elements lack alt text, making it slightly less friendly for screen readers.
Keyboard Navigation	Well-supported; users can navigate through categories and filters using only a keyboard.	Limited — some dropdowns and filters need mouse interaction.
Keyboard Navigation	Well-supported; users can navigate through categories and filters using only a keyboard.	Limited — some dropdowns and filters need mouse interaction.
Accessibility Enhancements	Voice search, image-based search, and smart recommendations improve ease of use for all.	Tooltips, visual filters, and product videos make browsing easier for visual learners.

Conclusion

• Amazon excels in functionality, trust, and reliability — ideal for practical shoppers.
• Nykaa delivers a superior visual and curated experience — ideal for beauty enthusiasts.
• Recommendation: Nykaa can improve by enhancing navigation for broader categories, while Amazon can simplify UI for faster beauty product discovery.